

Brainstorming – Idea Generation – Prioritization

Step 1: Team Gathering and Problem Identification

A brainstorming session was conducted among the project team members to identify real-world problems faced by students and librarians in library management. The team discussed various challenges encountered in the existing manual library system and analyzed possible solutions that could be implemented using the ServiceNow platform.

During the discussion, several issues were identified, such as difficulties in tracking book requests, delayed communication between students and librarians, lack of automated notifications, manual record maintenance, and the absence of a centralized monitoring system.

After evaluating the identified problems, the team decided to focus on improving the library book request process through automation.

Problems Identified

- Manual book request process
- Difficulty in tracking request status
- Delayed communication between students and librarians
- Lack of automated notifications
- Paper-based record maintenance
- No centralized request monitoring system
- Time-consuming approval process
- Limited reporting and analytics capabilities

Selected Problem Statement

To develop a **Library Book Request System** using ServiceNow that automates book request submission, request tracking, approval management, email notifications, and dashboard reporting.

Step 2: Idea Generation

The team generated multiple ideas to address the identified challenges and improve library operations. Each idea was discussed based on its usefulness, implementation feasibility, and potential impact on students and library staff.

Generated Ideas

1. Library Book Request System
2. Online Book Reservation System
3. Library Notification Management System
4. QR Code-Based Book Tracking System
5. Student Library Mobile Application
6. Digital Library Portal
7. Library Analytics Dashboard
8. Smart Book Recommendation System
9. Automated Approval Workflow
10. Library Asset Management System

Idea Categorization

Request Management

- Library Book Request System
- Online Book Reservation System
- Automated Approval Workflow

Communication and Notifications

- Library Notification Management System
- Student Library Mobile Application

Analytics and Monitoring

- Library Analytics Dashboard
- Digital Library Portal

Advanced Library Automation

- QR Code-Based Book Tracking System
- Smart Book Recommendation System
- Library Asset Management System

Step 3: Idea Prioritization

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After generating multiple ideas, the team carefully evaluated each idea based on feasibility, implementation complexity, user requirements, expected benefits, and compatibility with the ServiceNow platform.

The Library Book Request System was identified as the most suitable solution because it directly addresses the challenges faced by students and librarians in managing book requests. Compared to other ideas, this solution provides a practical and efficient approach for automating the request process while requiring fewer resources and development effort.

Considered Ideas

- Library Book Request System
- Online Book Reservation System
- Library Notification Management System
- QR Code-Based Book Tracking System
- Student Library Mobile Application
- Digital Library Portal
- Library Analytics Dashboard
- Smart Book Recommendation System

Final Selected Idea

Library Book Request System

Reasons for Selecting the Idea

- Solves a real-world problem faced in educational institutions.
- Simplifies the book request process for students.
- Reduces manual work for librarians.
- Enables automated request tracking.
- Provides automatic email notifications.
- Supports approval and rejection workflows.
- Improves transparency and communication.
- Generates reports and dashboard analytics.
- Easy to implement using ServiceNow.
- Scalable for future enhancements.

Expected Benefits

The proposed system will help students submit book requests online without visiting the library physically. Librarians can easily monitor requests, approve or reject them, and maintain records in a centralized system. Automated notifications ensure better communication, while dashboards provide valuable insights into library operations.

Conclusion

Based on the brainstorming discussions and evaluation of all proposed ideas, the Library Book Request System was selected as the final project idea. The solution offers an effective combination of automation, usability, and ServiceNow functionality, making it the most suitable choice for improving library request management.

